NOVEMBER IS TURTLE MONTH

Three freshwater turtles live in Mitchell Shire. All three are in decline.

See it. Snap it. TurtleSAT it.

From October to December the females leave the Goulburn River, Sunday Creek, King Parrot Creek and the farm dams between them, cross roads and dig nests in open paddocks. That is when you will see them, and when foxes dig up most of the eggs. **Every sighting you record on TurtleSAT shows scientists where turtles still live, nest and die, and where fox control and road signs will do the most good.**



Eastern Long-necked Turtle

Chelodina longicollis

Shell usually under 25 cm. Neck nearly as long as the shell, folded sideways. The one most often seen on roads after rain. **Still common, but declining.**



Broad-shelled Turtle

Chelodina expansa

Victoria's largest, shell to 46 cm, with a very long neck and a flat oval shell. Rarely leaves deep water except to nest. **Endangered in Victoria.**



Murray River Turtle

Emydura macquarii

Short neck, shell to 32 cm, a pale stripe behind each eye. Basks on logs in the Goulburn and larger creeks. **Critically endangered in Victoria.**

1 See it

A turtle on the road, crossing a paddock, basking on a log, or a dug-up nest with leathery eggshells beside a dam. Dead turtles count too.

2 Snap it

One photo from a few steps back is enough. Keep clear of traffic, and leave a female alone while she is digging.

3 TurtleSAT it

Open the free TurtleSAT app, add the photo and let it take the location. Two minutes.

Scan to record a sighting

turtlesat.org.au, or search TurtleSAT in the App Store or Google Play.

South West Goulburn Landcare Network

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Main photo: an Eastern Long-necked Turtle digging her nest, 26 November 2019. Species photos and conservation status from "Freshwater Fish, Crayfish and Turtles of North East Victoria", DEECA 2023, CC BY 4.0. TurtleSAT and Turtle Month are run by the 1 Million Turtles program at Western Sydney University.